

# Detroit Pistons



## All-Star Selection Guide

Role-Play: the head coach for an Eastern Conference Team would like some assistance in picking out the reserves for the 2026 Eastern Conference All-Star Team. This analysis applies scoring efficiency and complementary impact metrics as the foundation for identifying the most deserving candidates for the remaining 7 roster spots.

The following six players currently lead the Eastern Conference in fan voting:

1. Tyrese Maxey,
2. Jaylen Brown,
3. Donovan Mitchell,
4. Giannis Antetokounmpo,
5. Jalen Brunson, and
6. Cade Cunningham.

Given historical voting trends and All-Star selection patterns, it is highly likely that five of these players will be named Eastern Conference starters, with the remaining player positioned as a strong candidate for the first Eastern Conference reserve.

This analysis focuses on identifying the remaining Eastern Conference All-Star reserves, excluding the presumptive starters listed above. The goal is to provide a data-informed guide that balances efficiency, offensive responsibility, availability, team success, and overall impact.

While two-way impact and defensive contributions are important components of overall player value, this analysis intentionally places greater emphasis on the offensive side of the ball. Historically, the NBA All-Star Game environment features limited defensive intensity and places a premium on scoring, shot creation, efficiency, and offensive versatility. As a result, offensive production tends to be a stronger differentiator for All-Star selection and in-game impact than defensive metrics alone.

This approach aligns with both historical All-Star selection trends and the practical realities of the event itself, where players are evaluated not only on season-long performance but also on their ability to contribute to a fast-paced, offense-driven exhibition. Defensive impact is therefore treated as a secondary consideration in this analysis, while offensive efficiency, responsibility, and availability serve as the primary drivers for identifying reserve candidates.

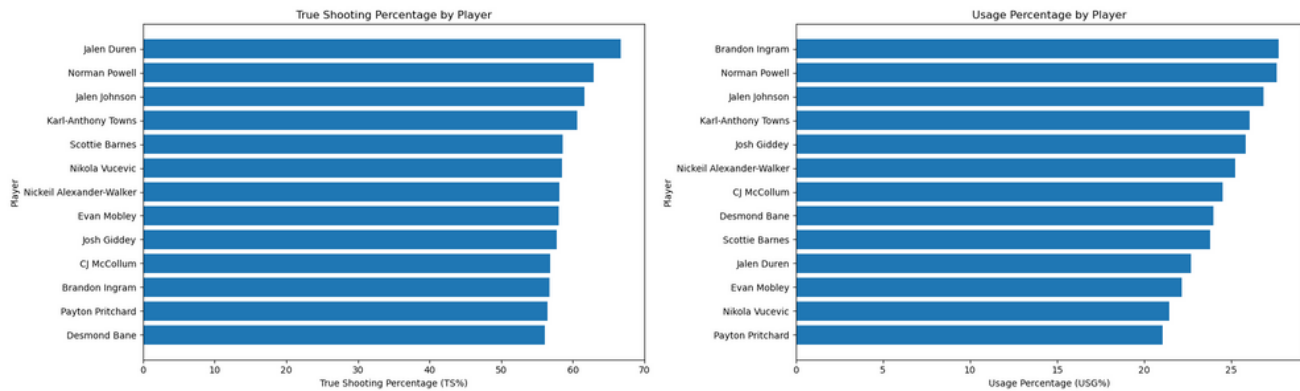
We begin with the Top 40 Eastern Conference players by performance and impact, then refine the pool using the following criteria:

1. Team Competitiveness
  - Player must be on a Top 10 Eastern Conference team, ensuring relevance to the playoff race.
2. Availability and Reliability
  - Player must have appeared in at least 30 games, emphasizing sustained contribution.
3. Offensive Responsibility
  - Player must carry a Usage Rate (USG%) of at least 20%, indicating meaningful involvement in offensive creation.
4. Scoring Efficiency
  - Player must post a True Shooting Percentage (TS%) of at least 56%, ensuring efficiency alongside volume.
5. Fan Voting Threshold
  - Player must have fewer than 1 million fan votes, effectively excluding the six leading vote-getters already identified as likely starters.

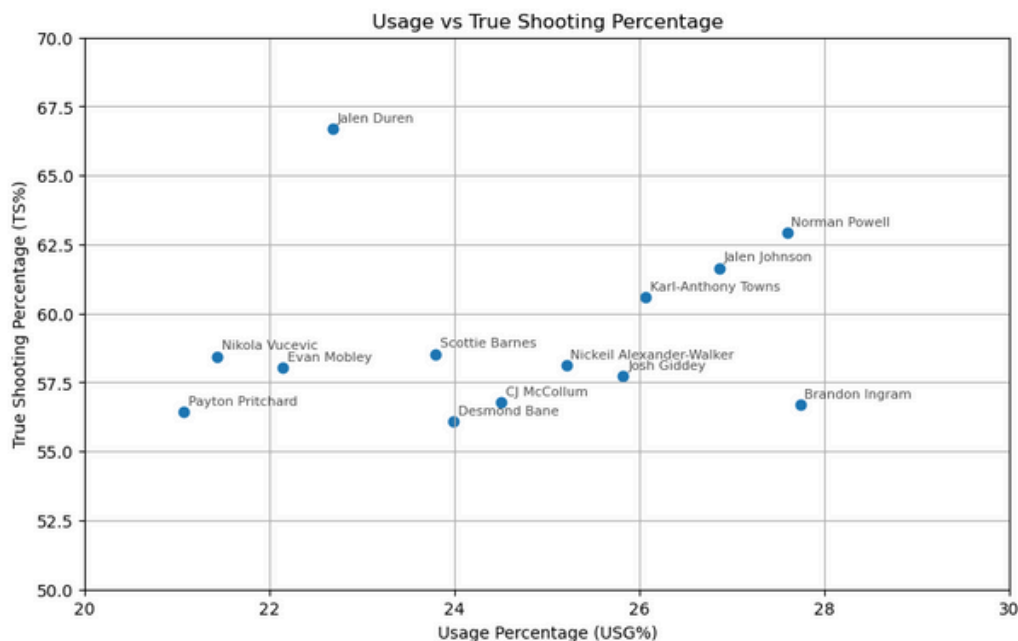
By applying these filters, the analysis isolates a group of players who combine impact, efficiency, and availability while remaining realistic reserve candidates. The resulting evaluation is designed to support coaching decision-making when finalizing the six remaining All-Star reserve selections for the Eastern Conference.

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- **Jalen Duren** stands out as the most efficient scorer in the group, posting the highest True Shooting Percentage while operating at a relatively modest usage rate. This profile highlights elite finishing efficiency without requiring the offense to run through him. As an efficiency outlier, Duren would be especially valuable in an All-Star lineup already featuring primary creators, where complementary scoring and finishing are critical.
- **Norman Powell** and **Jalen Johnson** both rank near the top of the group in both usage rate and True Shooting Percentage, indicating an ability to shoulder offensive responsibility without sacrificing efficiency. Their combination of above-average usage and above-average efficiency makes them strong candidates for All-Star reserve roles.
- **Karl-Anthony Towns** remains highly efficient despite carrying significant offensive responsibility. His ability to maintain above-league-average efficiency at a high usage rate reinforces his value as a reliable offensive anchor and a proven scoring option in varied lineup configurations.
- **Brandon Ingram** demonstrates high usage with comparatively lower efficiency, suggesting heavy offensive responsibility but slightly reduced shot quality. **Scottie Barnes**, while closer to the middle of the pack in both metrics, provides steadier efficiency and contributes across multiple facets of the game. Given Toronto's team success, either player would be a defensible All-Star selection depending on roster construction needs.
- The Orlando Magic, currently holding the 6th seed in the Eastern Conference, merit All-Star representation based on sustained team performance. While **Paolo Banchero** did not meet the efficiency threshold used in this analysis (54.91% TS%), he remains the offensive engine of the team and contributes in multiple non-scoring dimensions. An argument for Banchero's All-Star case would require analysis into TRBs, ASTs, and defensive metrics, which is outside the scope of this analysis. His teammate, **Desmond Bane**, clears the efficiency cutoff at 56.09% TS% while maintaining meaningful usage, positioning him as a good All-Star reserve candidate under this framework.



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| Player                   | USG%   | TS%    | Conference Seeding |
|--------------------------|--------|--------|--------------------|
| Jalen Duren              | 22.67% | 66.69% | 1                  |
| Norman Powell            | 27.59% | 62.94% | 8                  |
| Jalen Johnson            | 26.86% | 61.65% | 9                  |
| Karl-Anthony Towns       | 26.06% | 60.60% | 2                  |
| Scottie Barnes           | 23.79% | 58.53% | 4                  |
| Nikola Vucevic           | 21.43% | 58.44% | 10                 |
| Nickeil Alexander-Walker | 25.20% | 58.14% | 9                  |
| Evan Mobley              | 22.14% | 58.02% | 7                  |
| Josh Giddey              | 25.82% | 57.72% | 10                 |
| CJ McCollum              | 24.50% | 56.79% | 9                  |
| Brandon Ingram           | 27.73% | 56.80% | 4                  |
| Payton Pritchard         | 21.06% | 56.45% | 3                  |
| Desmond Bane             | 23.98% | 56.09% | 6                  |

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### My Picks for Eastern Conference All-Stars

| Player                             | Team                | Conference Seeding |
|------------------------------------|---------------------|--------------------|
| Giannis Antetokounmpo              | Milwaukee Bucks     | 11                 |
| Tyrese Maxey                       | Philadelphia 76ers  | 5                  |
| Jaylen Brown                       | Boston Celtics      | 3                  |
| Jalen Brunson                      | New York Knicks     | 2                  |
| Cade Cunningham                    | Detroit Pistons     | 1                  |
| Donovan Mitchell                   | Cleveland Cavaliers | 7                  |
| Jalen Duren                        | Detroit Pistons     | 1                  |
| Norman Powell                      | Miami Heat          | 8                  |
| Jalen Johnson                      | Atlanta Hawks       | 9                  |
| Karl-Anthony Towns                 | New York Knicks     | 2                  |
| Scottie Barnes (or Brandon Ingram) | Toronto Raptors     | 4                  |
| Paolo Banchero (or Desmond Bane)   | Orlando Magic       | 6                  |